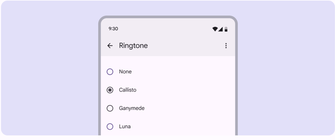
Radio button

Radio buttons let people select one option from a set of options

Resources +2

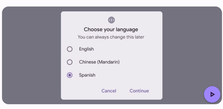


Radio buttons

Usage

Radio buttons are the recommended way to allow users to make a single selection from a list of options.

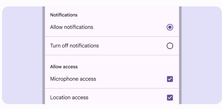
Only one radio button can be selected at a time.



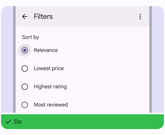
Radio buttons should always be accompanied by clear inline labels

Use radio buttons to:

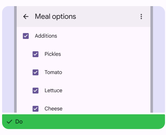
- Select a single option from a set
- Expose all available options



Radio buttons are single-select, unlike checkboxes which are multi-select



Use radio buttons when only one option can be selected from a list



Use checkboxes when multiple options can be selected from a list

Avoid nesting radio buttons or using radio buttons to select multiple options.

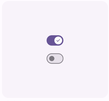
Don't nest radio buttons

Don't allow radio buttons to select multiple options

Alternate selection controls

Radio buttons are one of several selection controls, which allow people to make choices such as selecting options or switching settings on or off.

Switches and checkboxes are alternative selection controls that can be used to change settings or preferences.

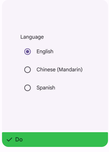


Switches

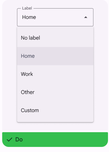
Checkboxes

Use radio buttons when there are five or fewer options.

Consider using a drop-down menu instead of radio buttons when it's important to save space on a screen. However, drop-down menus require additional steps for a person, both in the number of clicks and cognitive effort.



Use radio buttons when there are five or fewer options



Consider using a drop-down menu instead of radio buttons when space is constrained

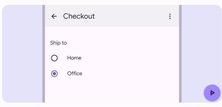
Anatomy

1. Selected icon
2. Adjacent label text
3. Unselected icon

Adjacent label text

Always pair radio buttons with an adjacent label describing what the radio button selects.

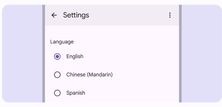
Because only one radio button can be selected at a time, each choice must have its own label.



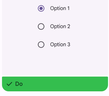
Radio button always need label text

Placement

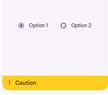
Radio buttons are often arranged in stacked layouts.



Radio buttons should be vertically listed and have one option always selected.



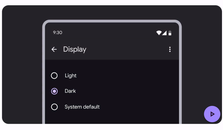
Radio buttons should always have one option pre-selected



Avoid using horizontal radio button lists

Behavior

A radio button is successfully selected when a person clicks or taps either the radio button icon or the label.



Radio buttons should take effect immediately, unless they're in a dialog or page that needs to be saved